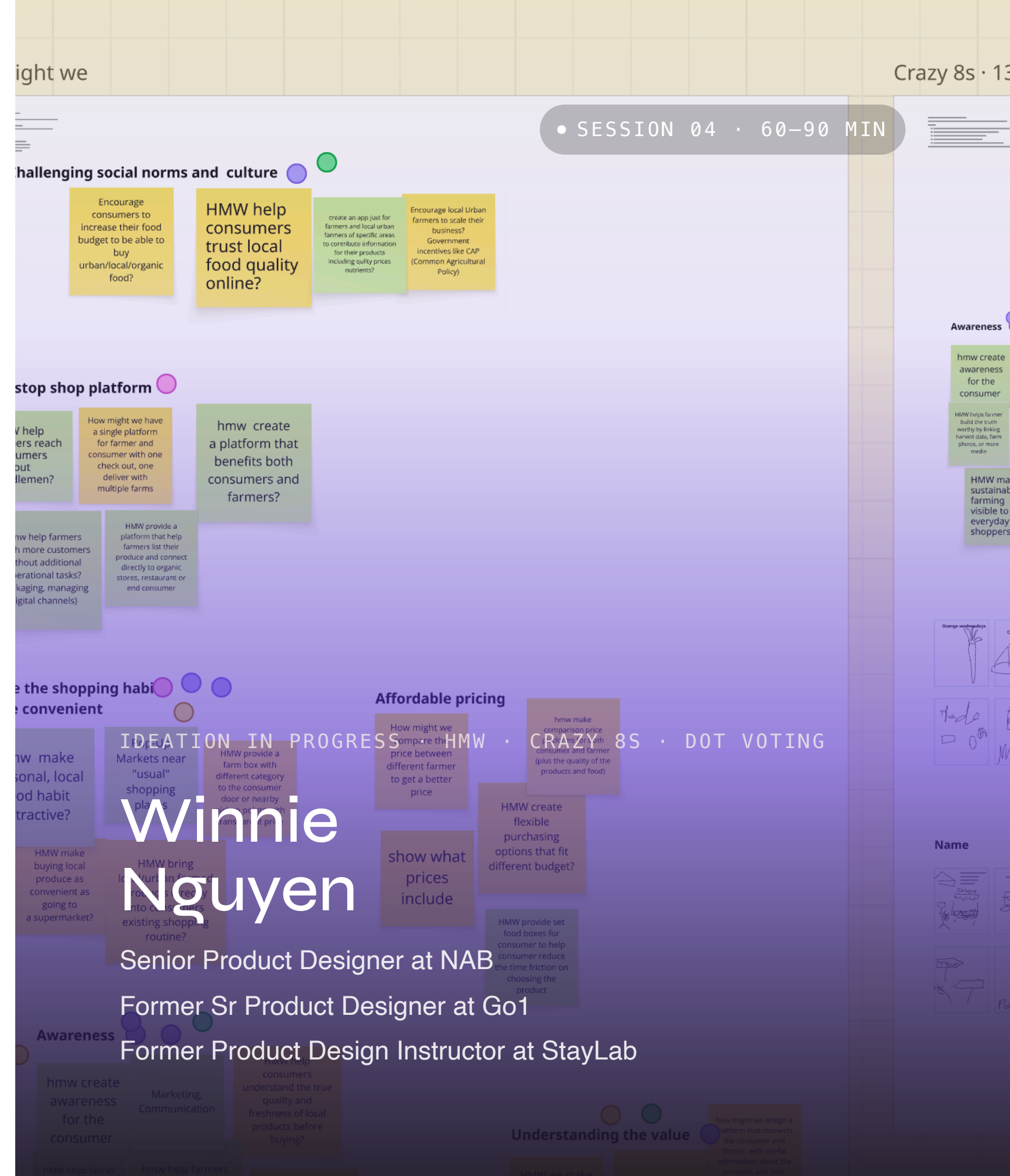


SESSION 04

Develop Solutions & Ideate

From problem to idea to decision — without jumping to screens.



LAST SESSION • RECAP

Information Architecture

You moved from understanding users to understanding the structure of the product they're moving through.

WHAT YOU LEARNED

- Distinguishing inherited IA from evidence-based IA
- Card sorting to understand how users mentally group content
- Drawing a current-state and evidence-based sitemap
- Mapping user flows to find structural friction

YOUR ASSIGNMENT

- Map the current-state user flow for one core task
- Annotate each step as User, System, or Third Party
- Identify the highest-friction step — and explain why it exists

From problem, to ideas, to a decision you can defend.

01	Opportunity Tree Map the space between your problem and your solutions.	20 MIN EXPLAIN + ACTIVITY
02	Flow Review Revisit your user flow to find where and what to improve.	5 MIN QUICK EXPLAIN
03	Crazy 8s Generate more ideas than you think you need.	15 MIN EXPLAIN + TAKE HOME
04	Concept Sketching Make the best ideas visible enough to evaluate.	10 MIN EXPLAIN + ACTIVITY
05	Storyboarding Extend your concept across time — for your assignment.	5 MIN WALK-THROUGH
06	Prioritisation Choose what to develop, and why.	10 MIN EXPLAIN + ACTIVITY

MINDSET • THE BIG IDEA

The best solution is almost never the first one.

The most common failure in ideation is converging before you've explored widely enough. The value isn't the ideas — it's the distance you travel from your starting assumption.

THE ONE RULE DURING IDEATION

No evaluation while generating.

"Yes, and..." — not "Yes, but...". Write every idea down.
The bad ideas are fuel for the good ones.

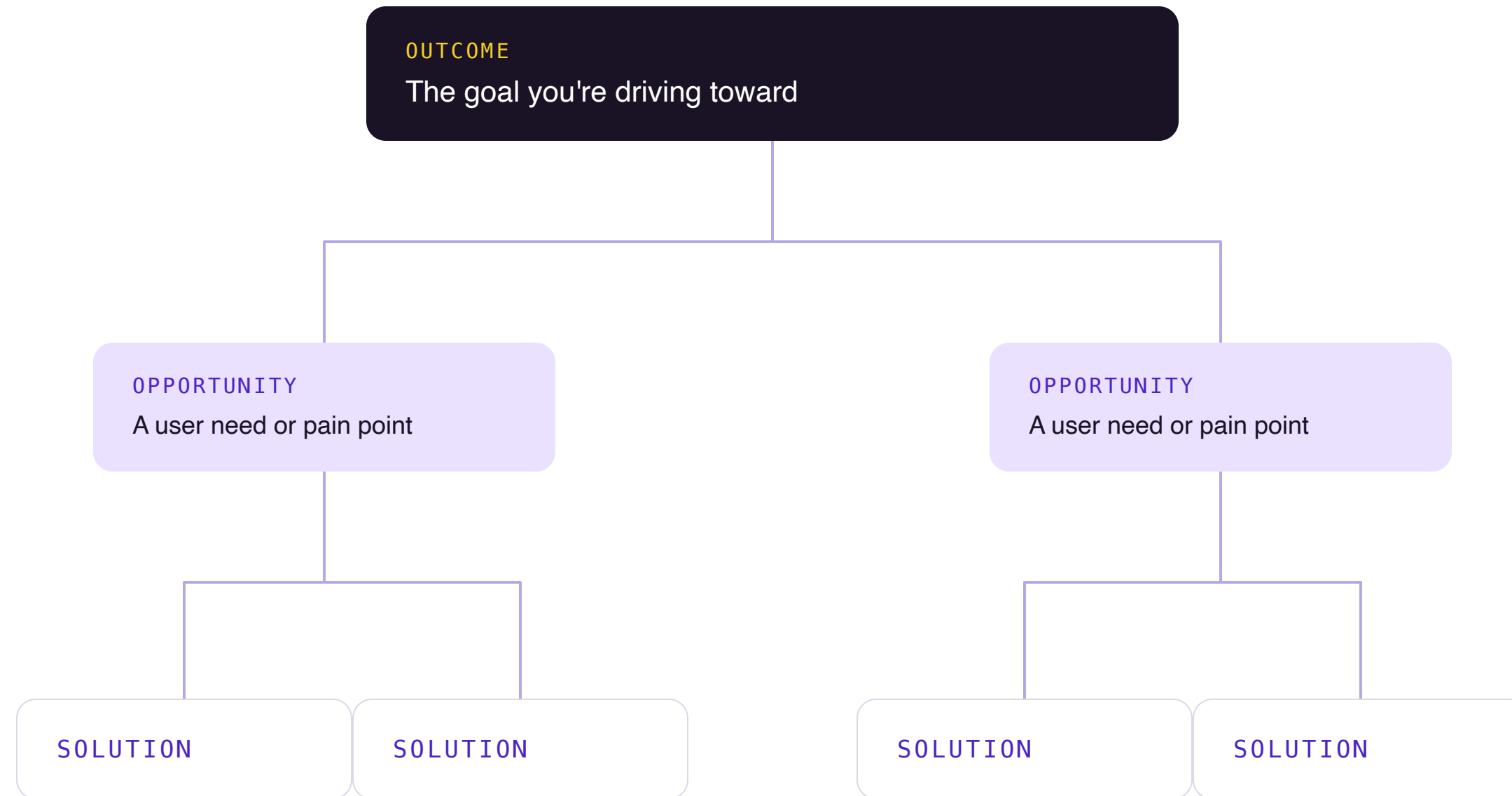
You will evaluate. That's what prioritisation is for. For
now, the only failure is stopping too soon.

01 PART ONE • 20 MIN

Opportunity Tree Mapping

Before you generate solutions, get clear on what opportunities exist. Most teams skip this step and pay for it later.

One outcome. A few opportunities. Many solutions.



THE OPPORTUNITY SOLUTION TREE · TERESA TORRES, CONTINUOUS DISCOVERY HABITS

Three levels — outcome, opportunity, solution.

Outcome

The goal you're designing toward. Your problem statement. **One root node.**

Freelancers lose projects because clients forget to respond within 48 hours of a proposal.

Opportunity

User needs and pain points that, if addressed, would move the user toward the outcome. **Not solutions — spaces where a solution could live.**

Freelancers want to keep the conversation warm without nagging.

Clients lose track of which proposals are still pending action.

Solution

Specific ideas that address an opportunity. They live **under** opportunities — not the outcome.

Scheduled, customisable follow-up nudges from the freelancer.

A shared "open decisions" inbox the client can sweep weekly.

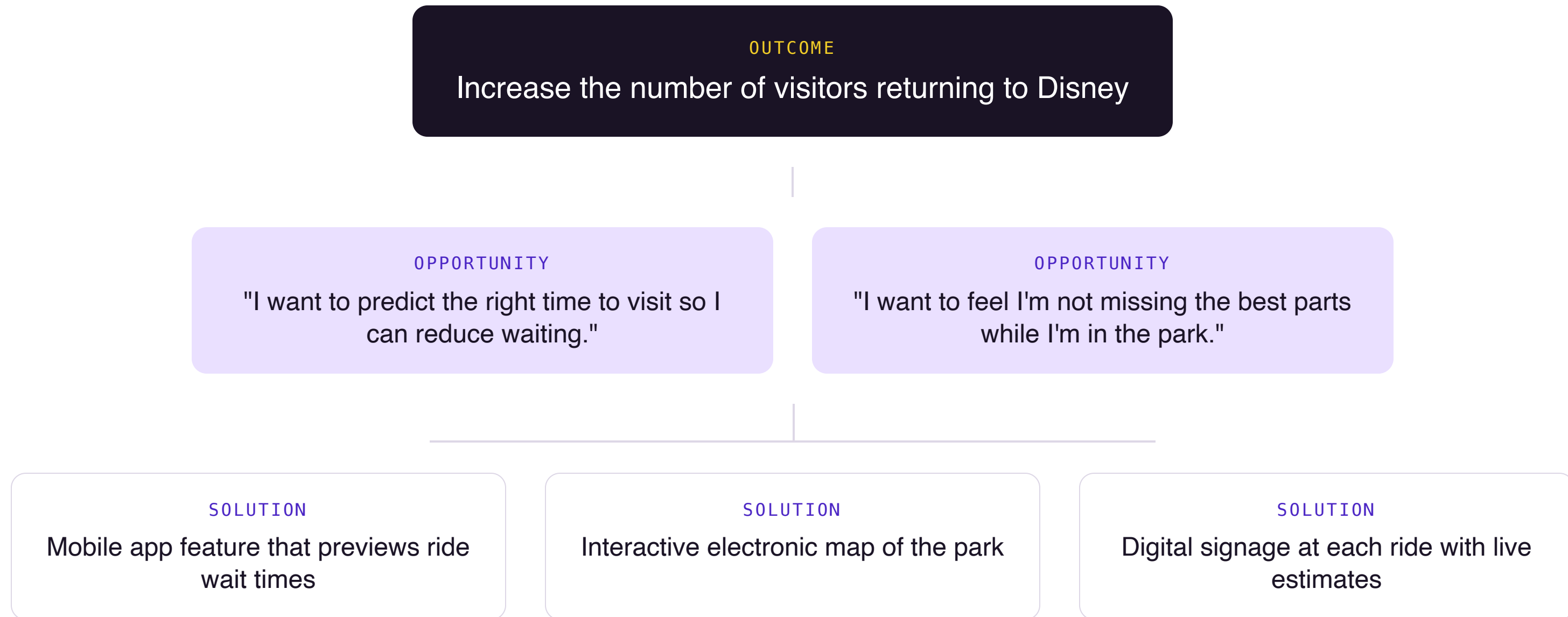
A read-receipt + soft "is this still a yes?" check at 48h.

How to build the tree.

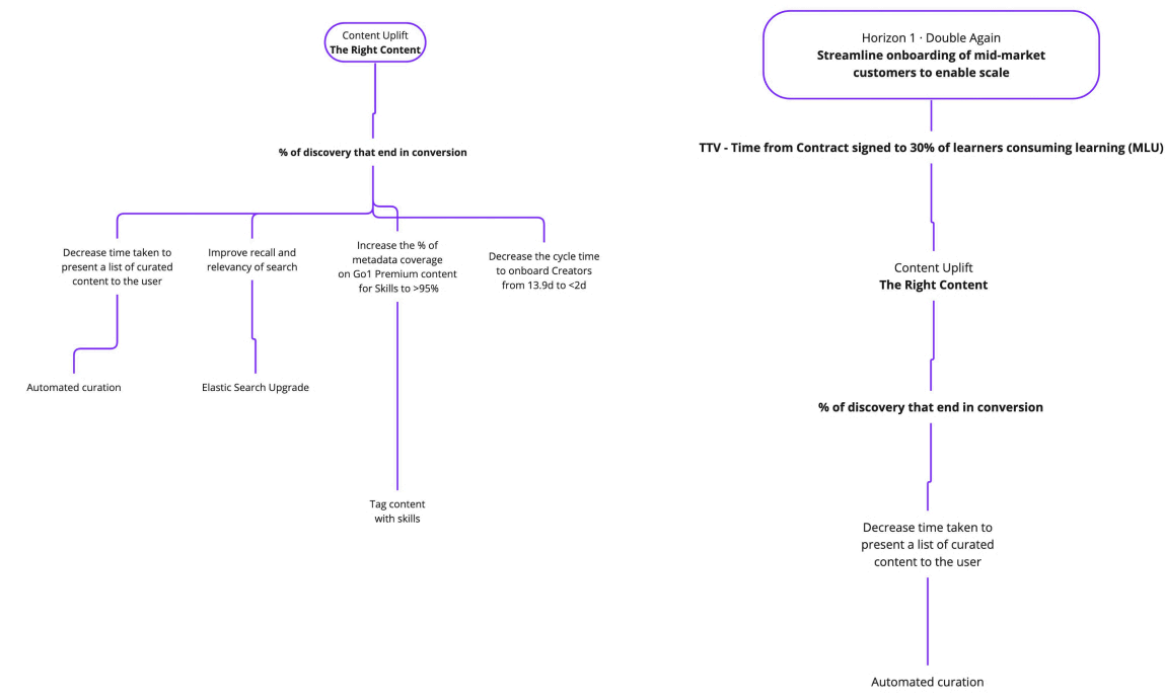
- 01 Start with your outcome**
Write your problem statement at the top. This is your root node.
- 03 Don't solve yet**
Go wide on opportunities before you touch solutions.
Resist the pull — that step comes next.
- 05 Read the shape**
Where are the dense branches? Where are the gaps?
The shape tells you where your thinking is underdeveloped.

- 02 Map the opportunities**
Ask: what are all the different user needs, pain points, or desires inside this problem? Aim for 5–8 before evaluating.
- 04 Branch solutions from opportunities**
For each opportunity, write 2–3 specific ideas underneath. These are your solution candidates.

Increase the number of visitors returning to Disney.



Here's one I built at Go1 — content curation, mid-market onboarding.



Map your tree.

Use your problem statement from Session 3 — or the practice scenario: **"Freelancers lose projects because clients forget to respond within 48 hours of a proposal."**

ROUND 01

5 MIN

Map opportunities

- Write your problem statement at the top.
- Generate user needs, pain points, desires — aim for at least 5.
- No solutions yet.

ROUND 02

7 MIN

Branch solutions

- Pick your 3 strongest opportunities.
- Write 2–3 specific solution ideas underneath each one.
- Don't worry if some sound rough — that's the point.

ROUND 03

3 MIN

Read the tree

- Which branch has the most solutions? The fewest?
- Any opportunity with no solution — and why?
- Did the tree surface anything you hadn't considered?

1B BEFORE WE MOVE ON • 10 MIN

Revisit your **Flow**.

Your Opportunity Tree lives in user space. Your user flow lives in product space. Now make them talk to each other.

Every friction point on the flow is a candidate opportunity on the tree.

IN THE FLOW	→ ON THE TREE
A step the user struggles with	→ An opportunity
A handoff that breaks down	→ An opportunity
A step that takes too long	→ An opportunity
A step with no clear outcome	→ An opportunity

02 PART TWO · 15 MIN

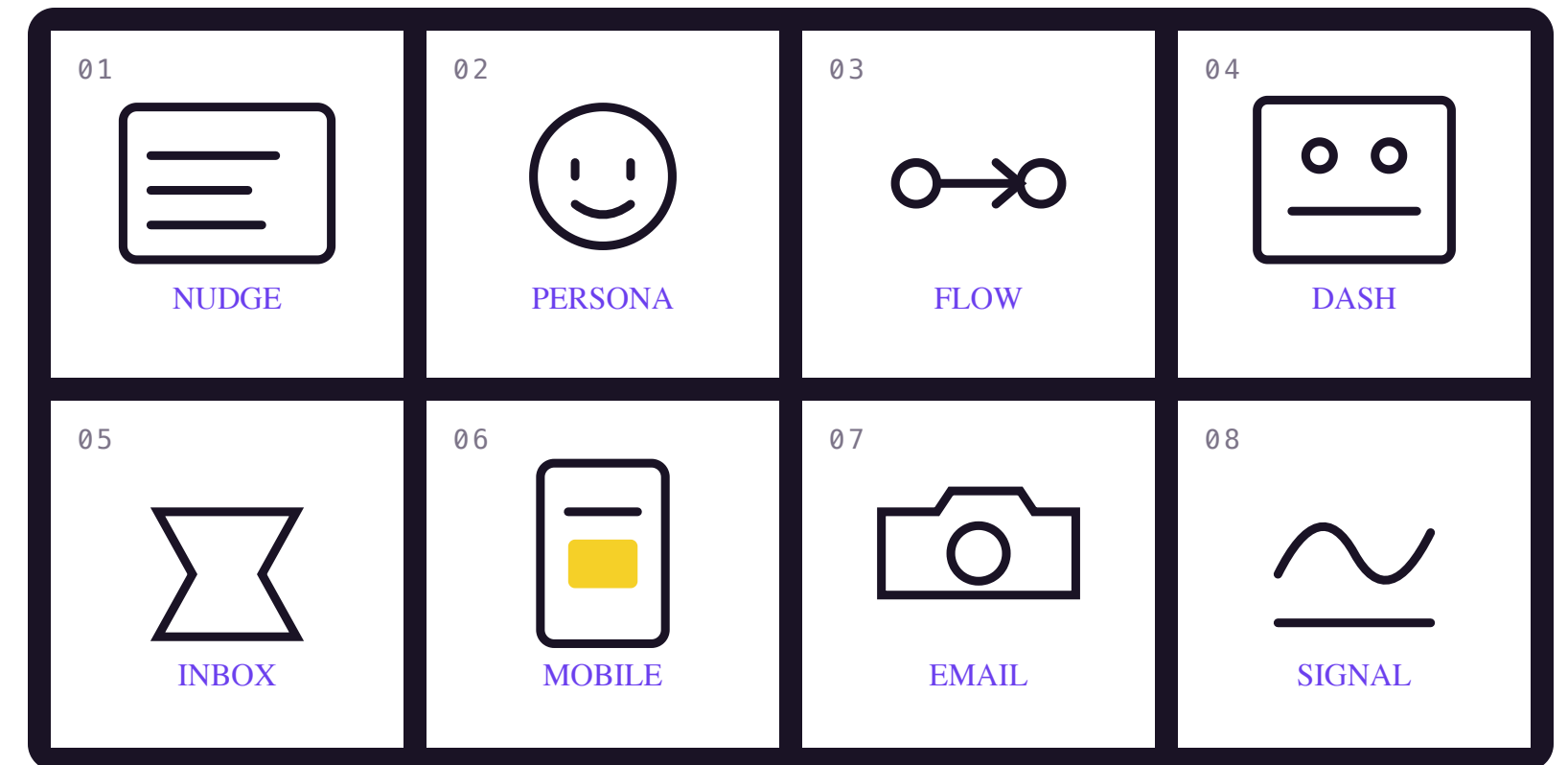
Crazy 8s

You have a map of the opportunity space and a clear flow direction. Now go wide on solutions — fast.

Crazy 8s — eight ideas in eight minutes.

Most people invest their best thinking in the **first idea that sounds viable**. Crazy 8s breaks that habit by forcing you to keep moving.

- 01** Fold A4 paper into 8 equal panels.
- 02** Timer on. 8 minutes total — roughly one per panel.
- 03** Sketch one idea per panel. Label each in 2–3 words.
- 04** No erasing. No perfecting. Move when the time is up.
- 05** Share back: pick your two most interesting panels.



HMW board on the left. Crazy 8s output on the right. Dot voting in the corner.



TAKE HOME • BEFORE NEXT SESSION

Try it on your own.

No time to run Crazy 8s in full today — but do it before next session, before your concept sketches.

STEP 01

Fold an A4 into eight panels.

STEP 02

Set a timer — eight minutes total.

STEP 03

Fill every panel — no skipping, no judging.

STEP 04

Circle your two most interesting panels — those become your concept sketches.

03 PART THREE • 20 MIN

Concept Sketching & Storyboarding

You have a range of directions. Now make the most promising ones visible enough to evaluate and develop.

A single rough illustration of one idea — showing what the solution **is, how it **works**, and why it's **different**.**

Not a wireframe. A thinking tool, not a deliverable. If you have to narrate it for it to make sense, it needs more labelling — not more detail.

How to sketch a concept.

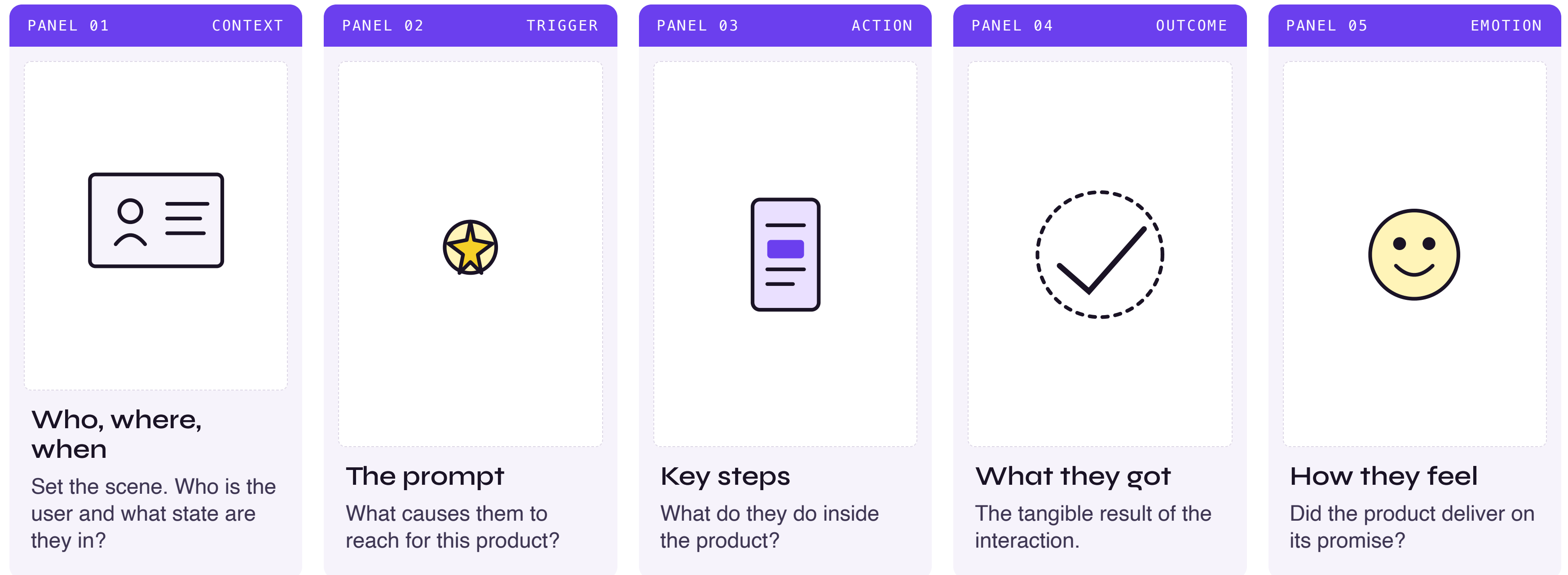
01 Pick one idea worth developing
From your Crazy 8s — usually the panel that surprised you or has the strongest underlying principle.

02 Draw the key moment
One screen, one interaction — the moment that makes the solution legible to someone seeing it for the first time.

03 Add labels, not polish
Name the components. Annotate the intent. A labelled scratchy sketch beats a polished unlabelled screen.

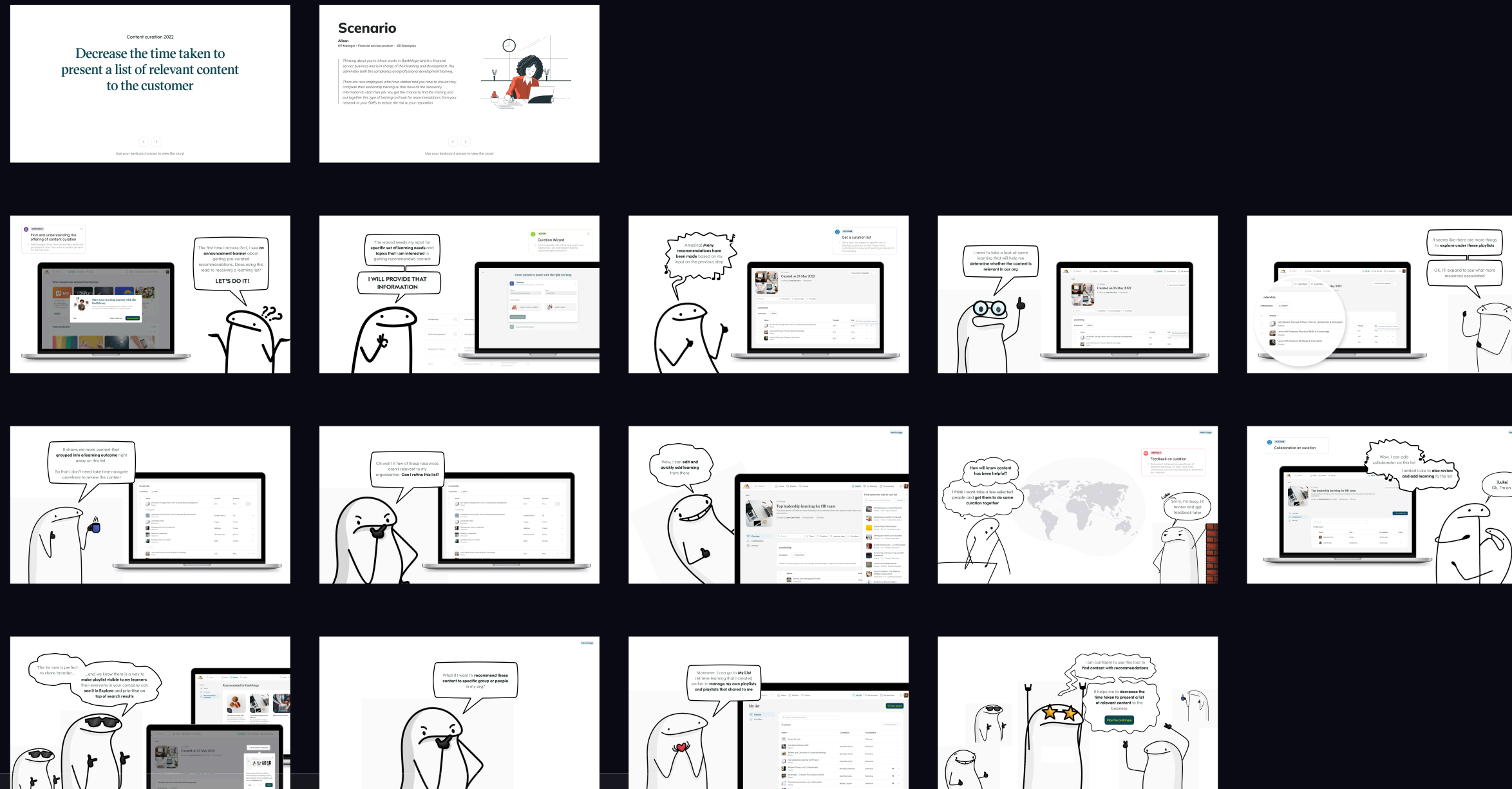
04 Write one sentence underneath
"This works because..." — if you can't finish the sentence, the concept needs more thinking, not more pixels.

Five panels — but three or four well-chosen is enough.



— FROM THE WILD · A REAL STORYBOARD

Allison's journey through content curation — start to finish.



G01 · CONTENT CURATION · TRIGGER → ACTION → OUTCOME

Sketch your concept.

Pick the strongest idea from your Crazy 8s — and make it visible enough to share.

THE TASK

7 MIN

Draw & label

- Sketch the key screen or moment.
- Label every component — name the parts, annotate the intent.
- Underneath, write: *"This works because..."*

SHARE BACK

3 MIN

Critique

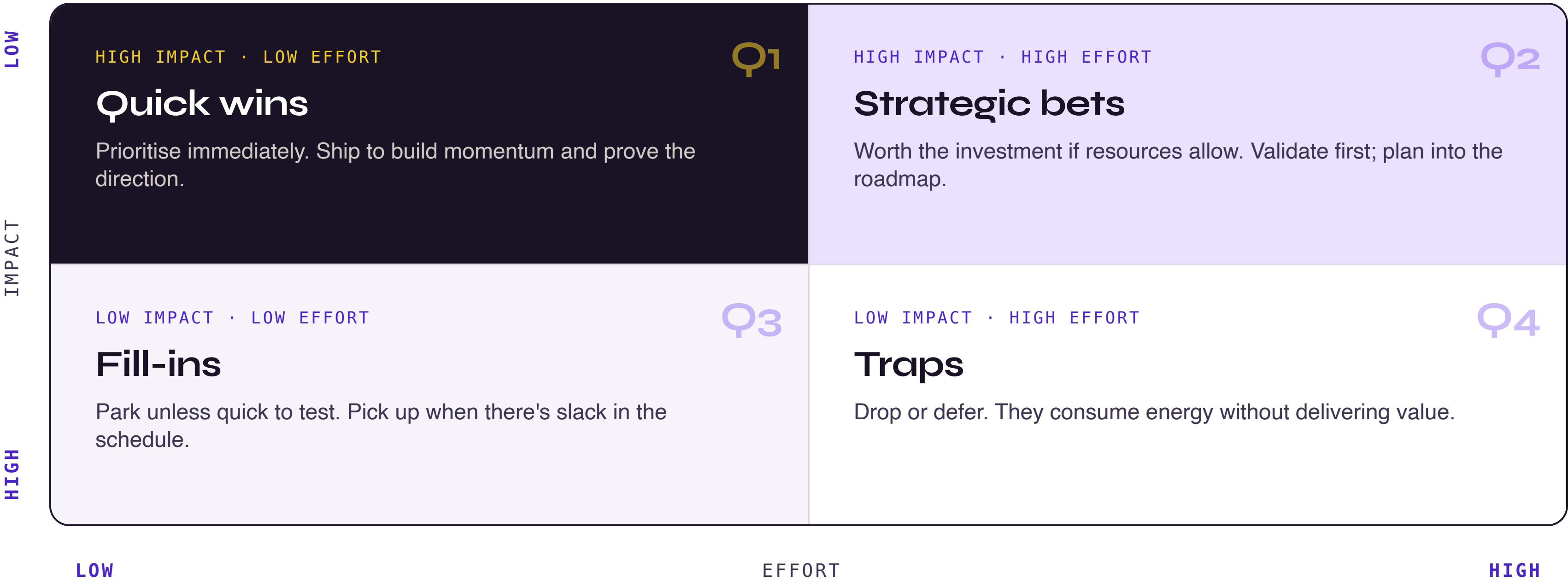
- Does your sketch make sense to someone who wasn't in your head?
- Where does it need more labelling?
- What did making the idea visible surface that the Crazy 8s panel didn't?

O4 PART FOUR • 10 MIN

Prioritisation — what to develop

You have concepts. Not all of them deserve the same investment.
Choose deliberately — and give yourself a defensible rationale.

Place each concept honestly — then decide.



Place your concepts, then commit.

ROUND 01

5 MIN

Place your concepts

- Draw the matrix on a whiteboard, FigJam, or paper.
- Write each concept on a sticky. Place them honestly.
- Connect each sticky back to the opportunity it came from on your tree.

ROUND 02

5 MIN

Make a decision

- Pick one concept to develop into a prototype.
- Write: *"I'm developing [concept] because [reason grounded in opportunity + matrix position]."*
- Did the matrix change what you thought the best option was?

Your assignment.

Deliver **two final concepts**, ready to share with your PO or a key stakeholder.

The goal isn't a "winning" concept. It's two directions, grounded in the opportunity space, that have been pressure-tested with a real stakeholder. Come ready to discuss which one they responded to, and why.

- 01** Build your Opportunity Tree and complete Crazy 8s — **use these to explore, not as deliverables.**
- 02** Select your top 2 concepts from the effort–impact matrix.
- 03** For each concept, prepare a refined sketch + a 3–4 panel storyboard (**Trigger → Action → Outcome**), plus one sentence on the opportunity it addresses and one on the assumption to validate.
- 04** Share both concepts with your PO or a key stakeholder. Note their response and any pushback.

— WANT TO GO DEEPER • OPTIONAL

The Google Design Sprint — five days, one decision.

Crazy 8s is one technique *inside* a larger structured process. If your team has a big unsolved problem and a week to focus, the full Sprint is worth running.

MONDAY	Map the problem and pick a target.
TUESDAY	Sketch competing solutions.
WEDNESDAY	Decide and storyboard.
THURSDAY	Build a realistic prototype.
FRIDAY	Test with real users.

SEE YOU NEXT CLASS

Thank you!

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